

WV WORKS:

Additional Financial Opportunities to Help You in the Workforce

WV WORKS provides financial assistance to help you find and keep employment. These awards are made based on need and could continue for 6-12 months after you have started your new job. It is important to follow your Personal Responsibility Contract and Self-Sufficiency Plan that you and your Case Manager developed to qualify for these payments. Submitting completed timesheets by the date required is extremely important to avoid delay or non-issuance of the payment that you may have requested.

Ask your WV WORKS worker about the following financial support services and bonus payments:

Transportation: Up to \$345/month depending on weekly participation.

Car Repairs: Up to \$2,000 lifetime limit to repair a car or truck to help you get to and from work.

Car Insurance: Up to \$1,500 lifetime liability car insurance.

Work Clothing: \$200/12 month period and \$1,000 lifetime limit for work clothing.

Collateral Expense: Payments up to \$450 in a 12-month period to help purchase items or services you may need for a new job.

Tools and/or Equipment: Up to \$1,000 lifetime for tools or other equipment needed for work.

Driver/Chauffeur License: Up to \$50 lifetime limit for either type of license.

Commercial Driver's License (CDL): Up to \$100 lifetime limit for a commercial driver's license.

Professional License: Up to \$300 lifetime limit if your new job requires you to be licensed.

Relocation Expense: Up to \$1,500 lifetime limit per household to relocate to another area of the state or different state due to employment.

Driving Under the Influence (DUI): Up to \$750 lifetime limit for costs related to reinstatement of driver's licenses revoked due to substance abuse. Payment may also include fines and fees related to traffic, moving and parking violations.

Vision and Dental Services: You may be eligible for a referral for vision and/or dental services to prepare you for your new job. You must be a work-eligible individual at the time of referral, but services will continue even if your WV WORKS case is closed. The referral is time-limited and services must be completed within one year of the referral date.

High School Graduation or Equivalent: Work-eligible individuals over the age of 18 who pass the high school equivalent diploma testing are eligible for a one-time bonus of \$100.

Vocational Education and Employment Achievement: Individuals who find employment within 90 days of graduating from a vocational education institution are eligible for a one-time bonus of \$250.

Job Retention: Achievement bonus of \$250/6 and \$500/12 months is paid for retaining full-time employment.

Participation Achievement: A bonus of \$50/month when participation requirements are met.

Your family may continue to receive support services or cash assistance for up to 6 months if you meet the following requirements:

- Continue to live in West Virginia; and
- Your family's gross monthly income is 150% or less of the current Federal Poverty Level; and
- Your family's countable assets remain below \$2,000; and
- One adult in the family meets all of the following:
 1. Is employed;
 2. Receives a monthly WV WORKS check or was a non-recipient work-eligible individual living with a dependent child receiving assistance; and
 3. Has a dependent child under age 19 in the home.

Note: Support service payments and bonus types/amounts may change. Certain eligibility requirements and restrictions may apply to some support payment types.

Additional services provided by the Bureau for Family Assistance include child care, Earned Income Tax Credit, Employer Incentive Program, Workforce Investment Opportunity Act, Joint Opportunities for Independence and domestic violence referrals.

For more information about WV WORKS Support Services, call your local DHHR office or visit the Bureau for Family Assistance website, <https://dhhr.wv.gov/bcf/Services/familyassistance>.